# CHAPTER 3: LOVE OUR WORLD

MEETING 1 — IDENTIFYING ENVIRONMENTAL ISSUES

BAHASA INGGRIS — KELAS VIII SMP
Mengenali masalah lingkungan, mempelajari kosakata, menjelaskan penyebab dan dampak, serta menyampaikan solusi sederhana.

## Learning Objectives

1. Identify environmental issues around us.
2. Use basic English vocabulary about the environment.
3. Describe environmental problems using simple sentences.
4. Explain the causes and effects of environmental problems.
5. Express simple ideas about protecting the environment.

Key Question: What environmental problems can you see around your home or school?

# A. What Is an Environmental Issue?

Environmental issues are problems that affect the natural world, including air, water, land, plants, animals, and human beings.

Artinya: Masalah lingkungan adalah permasalahan yang memengaruhi alam, termasuk udara, air, tanah, tumbuhan, hewan, dan manusia.

Examples: air pollution (polusi udara), water pollution (pencemaran air), plastic waste (sampah plastik), deforestation (penggundulan hutan), and flooding (banjir).

# B. Vocabulary: Environmental Issues

| Environmental Issue | Arti | Definition & Example |
|---|---|---|
| Air Pollution | Polusi udara | Air pollution happens when the air becomes dirty because of smoke and harmful gases.<br>Example: Cars produce smoke that pollutes the air. |
| Water Pollution | Pencemaran air | Water pollution happens when rivers, lakes, or seas become dirty.<br>Example: People throw rubbish into the river. |
| Plastic Waste | Sampah plastik | Plastic waste is discarded plastic that can harm the environment.<br>Example: Plastic bags can pollute the soil and water. |
| Deforestation | Penggundulan hutan | Deforestation happens when many trees are cut down.<br>Example: Deforestation destroys animal habitats. |
| Flooding | Banjir | Flooding happens when water covers land that is usually dry.<br>Example: Rubbish can block drains and contribute to flooding. |

## Additional Vocabulary

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Environment<br>Lingkungan | Pollution<br>Pencemaran | Rubbish / Trash<br>Sampah |
| Littering<br>Membuang sampah sembarangan | Dirty<br>Kotor | Clean<br>Bersih |
| Smoke<br>Asap | Harmful<br>Berbahaya | Drought<br>Kekeringan |
| Global warming<br>Pemanasan global | Climate change<br>Perubahan iklim | Recycle<br>Mendaur ulang |
| Reduce<br>Mengurangi | Reuse<br>Menggunakan kembali | Protect<br>Melindungi |

# C. Identifying Environmental Issues

To identify an environmental issue, look at three things: the problem, its cause, and its effect.

| 1. The Problem | 2. The Cause | 3. The Effect |
|---|---|---|
| What is happening?<br>Example: The river is dirty. | Why does it happen?<br>Example: People throw rubbish into the river. | What happens because of it?<br>Example: The water becomes polluted, and fish may die. |

| Issue | Cause | Effect |
|---|---|---|
| Air pollution | Vehicle smoke | Dirty air and breathing problems |
| Water pollution | Rubbish in rivers | Harm to aquatic life |
| Flooding | Blocked drains | Roads and houses may be flooded |
| Deforestation | Cutting down trees | Animals lose their habitats |
| Plastic waste | Using and throwing away plastic | Pollution of land and water |

# D. Useful Expressions

| Expression | Arti |
|---|---|
| I can see ... | Saya dapat melihat ... |
| There is ... | Ada ... (tunggal/tidak dapat dihitung) |
| There are ... | Ada ... (jamak) |
| The problem is ... | Masalahnya adalah ... |
| It happens because ... | Hal itu terjadi karena ... |
| It causes ... | Hal itu menyebabkan ... |
| In my opinion, ... | Menurut pendapat saya, ... |
| We should ... | Kita seharusnya ... |
| We must not ... | Kita tidak boleh ... |

Examples: I can see plastic waste near the school. There is a plastic bottle on the ground. There are many trees in the forest. We should keep our environment clean.

# E. Reading Comprehension

## A Dirty River Near Our School

Our school is near a small river. Every day, some people throw plastic bags and food waste into the river. The water becomes dirty and smells bad. Sometimes, the rubbish blocks the drains and contributes to flooding when it rains heavily.

This problem can harm fish and other aquatic animals. Students and local people should work together to keep the river clean. They can put rubbish in bins, reduce plastic use, and join river-cleaning activities.

### Vocabulary from the Text

- Waste = limbah
- Smells bad = berbau tidak sedap
- Blocks = menyumbat
- Aquatic animals = hewan air
- Work together = bekerja sama
- Reduce = mengurangi

# F. Practice Exercises — Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer (A, B, C, or D). The answer key and explanations are provided at the end.

**1. What is the main environmental issue in the text?**

A. Air pollution

B. Water pollution

C. Deforestation

D. Global warming

**2. What makes the river dirty?**

A. Plastic bags and food waste

B. Too many fish in the river

C. Clean water from the school

D. Trees growing near the river

**3. What can happen when rubbish blocks the drains?**

A. The air becomes colder

B. The forest grows larger

C. Flooding may occur

D. The river becomes cleaner

**4. Which sentence uses 'There are' correctly?**

A. There are a dirty river.

B. There are much smoke.

C. There are a plastic bottle.

D. There are many trees.

**5. Which action can help protect the river?**

A. Throwing rubbish into the water

B. Using more single-use plastic

C. Putting rubbish in bins

D. Blocking the drains with waste

**6. The word 'harm' in the text is closest in meaning to …**

A. Protect

B. Help

C. Damage

D. Clean

**7. Which statement is a cause of flooding mentioned in the text?**

A. Students clean the river

B. Rubbish blocks the drains

C. Fish live in the river

D. People reduce plastic use

**8. What is the purpose of the final paragraph?**

A. To describe a school building

B. To explain how to protect the river

C. To compare two different rivers

D. To tell a story about a fish

# G. Speaking Activity: Be an Environmental Detective!

Work in pairs. Observe your school environment or study a picture of an environmental problem. Discuss the questions below in English.

1. What environmental issue can you identify?
2. Where does it happen?
3. What causes the problem?
4. What are its effects?
5. What should we do to solve the problem?

## Example Dialogue

| | |
|---|---|
| A: | What environmental issue can you see? |
| B: | I can see plastic waste near the school. |
| A: | Why is it a problem? |
| B: | Because it makes the environment dirty and can pollute the soil. |
| A: | What should we do? |
| B: | We should put rubbish in bins and reduce plastic use. |

# H. Mini Project: My Environmental Observation

Create a short report based on your observation at home, at school, or in your neighborhood. Answer all five prompts.

| Part | Question | Your Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Place | Where did you observe the problem? | ..... |
| 2. Environmental issue | What is the problem? | ..... |
| 3. Cause | Why does it happen? | ..... |
| 4. Effect | What are its effects? | ..... |
| 5. Solution | What should people do? | ..... |

## Example Report

Place: My school.
Environmental issue: Plastic waste.
Cause: Students throw plastic bottles on the ground.
Effect: The school environment becomes dirty.
Solution: Students should put rubbish in bins and use reusable bottles.

## Suggested Assessment Rubric

| Aspect | Score |
|---|---|
| Vocabulary | 25 |
| Identification of the problem | 25 |
| Explanation of cause and effect | 25 |

| | |
|---|---|
| Suggested solution | 25 |
| Total | 100 |

# ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

Multiple-Choice Practice — Teacher's Reference

**1. B. Water pollution**

The river is dirty because people throw rubbish into it.

**2. A. Plastic bags and food waste**

The text says that people throw plastic bags and food waste into the river.

**3. C. Flooding may occur**

Blocked drains can contribute to flooding, especially during heavy rain.

**4. D. There are many trees.**

'Many trees' is plural, so it correctly uses 'There are'.

**5. C. Putting rubbish in bins**

Putting rubbish in bins helps prevent waste from entering the river.

**6. C. Damage**

'Harm' means to hurt or damage something.

**7. B. Rubbish blocks the drains**

The passage explains that rubbish can block drains.

**8. B. To explain how to protect the river**

The final paragraph suggests actions people can take to keep the river clean.

## Suggested Lesson Plan (2 × 40 minutes)

| Time | Activity |
|---|---|
| 15 minutes | Vocabulary introduction |
| 15 minutes | Reading comprehension |
| 20 minutes | Individual practice |
| 30 minutes | Pair discussion and mini project |